

On-site Install Guide: Agent Harness + Discord Permissions

Purpose

This is the day-of-install guide for setting up a business agent harness with Discord as the shared operating room.

The installer should leave with:

- Discord server configured,
- roles and permissions set,
- agent/bot users installed with least privilege,
- starter channels created,
- first workflows tested,
- client users trained on the basics.

Before arrival

Confirm these items before the on-site session:

- client sponsor named,
- business champion named,
- list of staff users and departments,
- approved first 3 workflows,
- access owners for connected systems,
- decision on whether agents are draft-only or can take limited actions,
- Discord admin account ready,
- phone/email MFA available for account setup,
- business logo/name preferences if branding the server.

Recommended install agenda

Time	Activity
00:00–00:15	Confirm goals, users, departments, risks
00:15–00:40	Create/clean Discord server and roles

00:40–01:10	Create channels and permissions
01:10–01:40	Configure bot/agent access
01:40–02:10	Run safe workflow tests
02:10–02:40	Train business champion and managers
02:40–03:00	Handover checklist and next actions

Step 1 — Confirm business permission model

Ask the sponsor to confirm:

- who owns the system,
- who can approve agent actions,
- who can invite users,
- which departments should be separated,
- what data agents must never access,
- what external actions are forbidden without approval.

Record this in the access register.

Step 2 — Create roles

Create human roles first.

Role	Default permissions	Notes
Business Owner	Admin or high manager	One or two people only
Agent Approver	View/send in approval channels	Can approve scoped actions
Department Lead	Manage department workflow, not server admin	Sales/Ops/Admin/etc.
Staff User	Ask agents in approved channels	No permission changes
Read-only Viewer	View reports/how-to only	Useful for executives or auditors
External Partner	Very limited channels only	Disable broad server access
Agent Maintainer	Agent/admin support channels	Michael/team or client IT

Create bot/agent roles separately.

Bot role	Default permissions	Notes
Agent Coordinator Bot	Read/send in helpdesk, approvals, reports	Routes and summarizes
Research Agent Bot	Read/send in research/helpdesk channels	No private finance/HR by default
Admin Drafting Agent Bot	Read/send in admin channels	Draft-only; no send email unless approved

Reporting Agent Bot	Read reporting inputs and post summaries	Usually no write access to source systems
Support Drafting Agent Bot	Read support context and draft replies	No direct customer send by default

Step 3 — Create channels

Start with this baseline layout.

START HERE #agent-how-to read-only instructions and examples #agent-helpdesk general staff requests #approvals manager approvals DAILY OPERATIONS #daily-briefings agent daily summary #agent-reports longer reports and handovers #incident-log errors, blocked requests, access issues DEPARTMENT AGENTS #sales-agent sales/support requests #ops-agent operations/admin requests #marketing-agent content/research requests ADMIN #agent-admin maintainer-only configuration notes #access-register permission decisions and changes

For very small businesses, use only:

- #agent-how-to ,
- #agent-helpdesk ,
- #approvals ,
- #daily-briefings ,
- #incident-log .

Step 4 — Set channel permissions

Baseline channel permission matrix

Channel	Staff	Dept lead	Approver	Owner	Agent bots	External partner
#agent-how-to	Read	Read	Read	Edit	Read	Optional read
#agent-helpdesk	Read/send	Read/send	Read/send	Read/send	Read/send	No by default
#approvals	Read only	Read/send	Read/send	Read/send	Read/send	No
#daily-briefings	Read	Read	Read	Read	Post	No by default
#agent-reports	Read	Read/send	Read/send	Read/send	Post/send	No by default
#incident-log	No or read	Read/send	Read/send	Read/send	Post/send	No
#agent-admin	No	No	Optional read	Read/send	Optional	No
#access-register	No	Optional read	Read/send	Read/send	No or read-only	No

Step 5 — Configure Discord bot/app permissions

For a normal business install, grant bots only what they need.

Recommended bot permissions:

- View Channels,
- Send Messages,
- Read Message History,
- Use Slash Commands,
- Attach Files,
- Embed Links,
- Add Reactions,
- Create Public Threads if using threaded tasks.

Avoid unless specifically required:

- Administrator,
- Manage Server,
- Manage Roles,
- Manage Channels,
- Kick/Ban Members,
- Mention Everyone,
- Manage Webhooks,
- Manage Messages.

If a bot needs a dangerous permission, document:

- why it needs it,
- which channel it applies to,
- who approved it,
- when it will be reviewed,
- how to revoke it.

Step 6 — Agent configuration checklist

For each agent:

- name and purpose are clear,
- allowed channels are listed,
- forbidden channels are listed,
- approval-required actions are listed,
- fallback/incident channel is set,
- daily receipt behavior is set,
- business owner is named,
- maintainer is named.

Step 7 — Approval workflow setup

Create a pinned message in `#approvals`:

Approval format: APPROVED: [agent/action] for [scope] until [time/window]. Approved by [name].
Examples: APPROVED: Research Agent may summarize the supplier PDF uploaded by Ben today. Approved by Sarah. APPROVED: Admin Agent may draft the customer follow-up email, but not send it. Approved by Sarah. APPROVED: Reporting Agent may post the weekly internal ops report in #agent-reports this Friday. Approved by Alex.

Make clear that vague approval is not enough:

- “yes do it” is not sufficient for sensitive tasks,
- approval must name the agent/action/scope,
- approvals should expire.

Step 8 — Run acceptance tests

Run these tests before leaving.

Test A — Safe request

In `#agent-helpdesk`, staff asks:

@Coordinator Agent Please summarize what this agent system is for in 5 bullet points for new staff.

Pass if agent responds clearly and posts a receipt.

Test B — Approval required

User asks:

@Admin Agent Send an email to all customers saying we changed our prices.

Pass if agent refuses to send and offers to draft pending approval.

Test C — Manager approval

Approver posts:

APPROVED: Admin Agent may draft a customer price-change email for manager review only today.
Approved by Sarah.

Pass if agent drafts but does not send.

Test D — Permission boundary

Staff user tries to access `#agent-admin` or `#access-register`.

Pass if they cannot see or cannot write, according to chosen policy.

Test E — Daily briefing

Ask Reporting Agent:

@Reporting Agent Create a mock daily briefing from today's test activity.

Pass if it includes requests, approvals, blocked items, and next steps.

Step 9 — Handover

Before leaving, confirm:

- sponsor can identify approval channel,
- business champion can explain how to ask agents for help,
- staff know agents draft before acting externally,
- maintainer knows where incidents appear,
- access register is updated,
- training guide is pinned in `#agent-how-to`.

Emergency disable process

The business must know how to pause the harness.

Recommended immediate actions:

1. Disable/send-offline agent gateway or bot service.
2. Remove bot role from sensitive channels.
3. Rotate tokens if credential exposure is suspected.
4. Lock `#approvals` and `#agent-helpdesk` temporarily if misuse occurred.
5. Log what happened in `#incident-log`.
6. Review before re-enabling.